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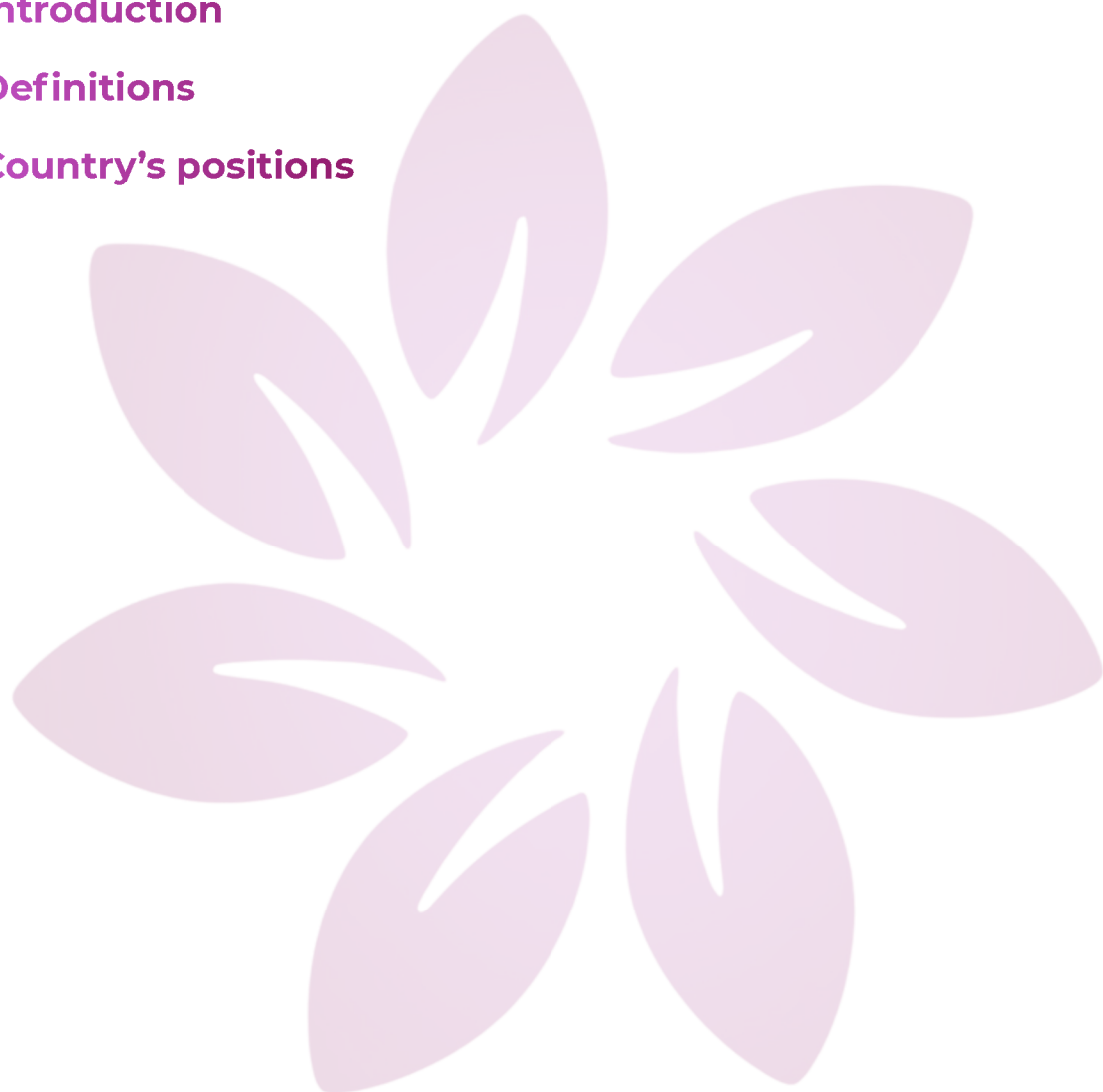
STUDY GUIDE

**Topic: Addressing Human
Rights Violations Arising
from the Extraction of
Critical Minerals in
Emerging Economies**



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1. MESSAGE FROM THE CHAIRS:

Dear Delegates,

It is our great pleasure to welcome you to the United Nations Human Rights Council. We are delighted to be discussing the important topic of “Addressing Human Rights Violations Arising from the Extraction of Critical Minerals in Emerging Economies” with you all.

In an increasingly dividing world, making compromises and trying to agree with one another may seem more difficult than ever, especially since many countries can possess completely different views from one another when it comes to supporting each other, environmental support, worker rights or, of course, human rights in general, especially considering wealth gaps and historical as well as cultural differences.

We kindly ask you that in the committee you represent your country adequately and accurately, respecting others’ opinions while striving for your own, while trying to come to compromises, since problems as big as this can’t be left unattended, they need action. Turn your challenges into opportunities that you can learn from, and also find ways to benefit your country.

Try your best to embrace the country you will be representing, even if it may have completely different values than you do, since it’ll only broaden your horizons in the end.

We are looking very forward to meeting you and seeing your heated debates in action, but then again, make sure your rivalries don’t get too heated. Good luck with your preparations, give it your best and see you in September!

Your Chairs

Liisa and Ana-Maria

2. THE HUMAN RIGHTS COUNCIL

The Human Rights Council is an intergovernmental body within the United Nations system responsible for strengthening the promotion and protection of human rights around the globe and for addressing situations of human rights violations and making recommendations on them. It has the ability to discuss all thematic human rights issues and situations that require its attention throughout the year.

The Human Rights Council does the following: Serves as an international forum for dialogue on human rights issues with UN officials and mandated experts, states, civil society, and other participants, adopts resolutions or decisions during regular sessions that express the will of the international community on given human rights issues or situations. holds crisis meetings known as special sessions to respond to urgent human rights situations, reviews the human rights records of all United Nations Member States via the Universal Periodic Review, appoints the Special Procedures, independent human rights experts who serve as the eyes and ears of the Council by monitoring situations in specific countries or by looking at specific themes and authorizes commissions of inquiry and fact-finding missions, which produce hard-hitting evidence on war crimes and crimes against humanity.

3. INTRODUCTION

Global demand for critical minerals such as lithium, cobalt, nickel, rare earth elements and many others is constantly surging due to the global transition onto renewable energy, digital technologies and advanced manufacturing. Said critical minerals are essential to producing for example electric vehicle batteries, solar panels and defense applications like weapons. Hence, such a high demand for minerals requires a big work force and therefore, the demand for miners rises. The rapid growth of extraction in emerging economies raises a critical question regarding human rights on topics like unsafe working conditions, child labor, forced labor and displacement of local communities. Factors such as weak governance, corruption, armed conflict and limited oversight in resource rich areas can further worsen these issues.

Mining has been crucial to the worldwide economy for centuries, but the global demand for critical minerals has transcended the industry in the last decade. Critical minerals are different from for example fossil fuels, which are harvested in relatively few regions, while critical minerals are mostly found and mined in many developing and emerging economies. Historically mining has often been associated with human rights concerns. Especially in the resource rich developing countries, factors like weak institutions, corruption and poor safety regulations have allowed mining to proceed with no regard to the health and safety of local populations. Child labor in artisanal cobalt mining has been extensively documented by the African Development Bank (AFDB, 2019), representing a human rights failure that the clean energy industry has been far too slow to confront.

The listed concerns pose a challenge for the international community. Although some minerals are necessary for achieving the objectives of the Paris Agreement and the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), the green energy transition should not come at the cost of fundamental human rights. The latest World Bank Group report, "Minerals for Climate Action: The Mineral Intensity of the Clean Energy Transition," finds that the production of minerals, such as graphite, lithium and cobalt, could increase by nearly 500% by 2050, to meet the growing demand for clean energy technologies. This could extremely increase intense workload for the miners and cannot be achieved ethically under current conditions. In the Human Rights Council, the goal of the delegates is to address how a multilateral community can strengthen the protection of human rights while also sustaining economic development. It should be ensured that the extraction, processing, transport and trade of critical minerals are conducted periodically.

4. DEFINITIONS

Critical minerals - minerals that are considered essential for economic development and emerging technologies while also being vulnerable to supply disruptions, for example lithium, cobalt, nickel, graphite, copper and rare earth elements. There is no single universally accepted list for critical minerals. Each country determines which minerals are critical based on their economic and strategic needs.

Emerging economies - countries experiencing fast industrialisation and economic growth but generally have lower income levels than advanced economies.

Forced labor - any work or service that a person has to do against their will through threats or deception.

Child labor - work performed by children that deprives them of their childhood, health, education or development, and which is prohibited under international labor standards established by the International Labor Organisation.

5. COUNTRY'S POSITIONS

Australia

Australia is one of the world's leading producers of critical minerals, it possesses large amounts of lithium, nickel and cobalt. Mining contributes a significant amount to the nation's economy. Their government also views increasing global demand for battery minerals as a big economic opportunity. Compared to many emerging economies, the mining industry in Australia has strong labor protections, workplace safety standards and environmental regulations. In their Critical Minerals Strategy 2023-2030, they claim to take into account the local First Nations peoples' (inhabitants of the land on which minerals are being mined) voices, in 2020, as a result of mining, the Juukan Caves, a 46000 year old spiritual heritage site in Australia was destroyed, leaving Indigenous Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people devastated as they lost an important part of their culture. In 2011 the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights (UNGPs) were unanimously endorsed by the UN Human Rights Council, which Australia agreed to implement.

The Commonwealth of Australia recognises that many developing countries that are resource rich often lack the regulatory capacity, infrastructure or expertise to manage the mining sustainably. Their foreign policy consequently promotes partnerships that would help to strengthen governance, improve transparency and encourage responsible business practices in the mining sector. Geoscience Australia and the Australian Trade and investment commission has aided developing countries before by giving geological expertise, resource mapping, technical training and support for regulatory frameworks.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- Environmental Protection and Biodiversity Conservation Act 1999
- Work Health and Safety Acts
- Critical Minerals Strategy 2023-2030
- Amnesty international
- Australian Trade and Investment Commission
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)

Brazil

Brazil is one of the most resource rich countries in the world and has significant reserves of critical minerals, like lithium, nickel, graphite and rare earth elements. Since global demand for the listed minerals is rising, it has become an increasingly bigger supplier for nations taking part in the global energy transition. However, Brazil itself is an emerging economy and has to therefore face balancing economic growth with not only human rights but also environmental conservation, since many mining sites can be found in or near the Amazon rainforest and indigenous territories. As an emerging economy, Brazil is ready to support others similar to itself, being a part of the South-South cooperation.

Brazil generally finds that issues related to human rights should be addressed through domestic governance, not external interference. Still, they support the UNGPs. Its National Mining Plan 2050 seeks integrating economic, social, environmental, and institutional dimensions, with a focus on securing the mineral supply and strengthening national sovereignty.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- Federal Constitution of 1988
- National Mining Policy
- National Mining Plan 2050
- South-South Cooperation
- Pro-Minerais Estratégicos
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international

Chile

Chile is one of the leading producers of minerals in the world and the largest producer of copper and second largest producer of lithium, making it an irreplaceable part of Chile's economy, since it's a big part of its exports and revenue. Its National Strategy for Critical Minerals states that „the country faces an unprecedented strategic opportunity, considering its geological potential, mining experience and specialized human capital, in an international context marked by competition to ensure responsible supplies of key minerals for clean technologies, electromobility and renewable energies.”

Lithium mining in Chile has had a big impact on the local environment. For example, mining in the Atacama desert can destroy local biodiversity and indigenous lifestyle, because of this the indigenous Atacameno and Colla have called for being able to participate in conversations affecting their territories. Chile has supported indigenous communities, for example the Atacameno are supported by a legal framework that recognises historical land rights and supports consultation. Chile is classified as an emerging economy, ready to help others through for example South-South cooperation.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- National strategy for Critical Minerals
- National Lithium Strategy
- South-South cooperation
- Amnesty international
- SFA Oxford- Chile critical minerals policy
- Chile National Corporation of Indigenous Development
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)

China

China is the world's leading processor of critical minerals. Although it produces some critical minerals, mainly rare earth elements, its focus lies more on refining and manufacturing. It's a big importer of cobalt, primarily from the Democratic Republic of the Congo, Lithium from Australia and Chile and nickel from Indonesia. China considers critical minerals as a matter of national security and economic development.

When it comes to human rights, China upholds the idea that economic development is fundamental to improving human rights. Bringing up the state in critical regions, it emphasises that mining projects should follow the laws of the host country. China finds that infrastructure investment and employment opportunities help towards improving living standards. However, in an article by The Carr-Ryan Center for Human Rights by the Harvard Kennedy School stated in 2025, that in the DRC, „There are more than 450 mining companies in the South Kivu Province, mostly run by Chinese nationals, but unfortunately, they are operating illegally due to a lack of compliance with current Congolese mining codes.” Coming to supporting emerging countries, China itself states that it has provided assistance to more than 160 developing countries including capacity building and poverty reduction.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- The State Council of the People's Republic of China
- MOFCOM
- Chinese global development Initiative
- Ministry of Natural Resources
- Chinese mining operations in the DRC
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international

Democratic Republic of the Congo

The Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) is the world's largest producer of Cobalt and the second-largest producer of copper. Its mining industry is responsible for nearly 99% of exports and around 46% of government revenues in 2021, making it arguably the most valuable prospect of the Congolese economy.

Although the DRC has enormous mineral wealth due to the mineral export, it is still facing challenges like poverty, weak governance, corruption, conflict and human rights abuse through the Rwandan military linked to mining. In 2022, the Human Rights Watch released an article about the rights violations in the DRC, claiming that, child labor and other serious human rights abuses in the mining sector remain widespread' and that almost 5.5 million people in the country were displaced and that 1 in 3 people faced dire food insecurity. In late 2025, an article provided by the Forest Peoples Programme claims the following: 'Furthermore, human rights and environmental impacts of mining activities are always accentuated in conflict-affected areas, where weak governance and security allow for unregulated extraction of minerals with little or no regard for social and environmental safeguards. This creates increased risks of deforestation, illegal land grabbing, gendered-based violence, forced labour, and other abuses of workers.'

Facing the discrimination of the Congolese, in 2007 the government established the Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative, which was meant to use foreign investment as a means to aid their citizens. Seeing the human rights violations continue today, it is clear that these measures aren't enough.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- Child Labor and Human Rights Violations in the Mining Industry of the Democratic Republic of Congo
- Forest peoples Programme: Between a rock and a hard place: human rights impacts in the DRC's mining sector

- Executive Industries Transparency Initiative (EITI)
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international

France

The French Republic has limited domestic production of minerals, therefore it relies heavily on imports for its nuclear energy sector, vehicle industry and defence industries. France also supports strengthening human rights protections and although it is striving towards sustainable green energy, it believes that green energy shouldn't come at the expense of workers or indigenous rights, or environmental protection. They are part of the EU Critical Raw Materials Act, which seeks to diversify mineral supplies and increase responsible sourcing and also the EU Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD) which requires large companies to conduct human rights and environmental due diligence across their chains. Taking for example the humanitarian crisis in the DRC, France has urged Rwandan troops to leave Congolese citizens alone and has helped the local economy by development projects supported by the French Development Agency (AFD) as well as university and scientific partnerships, as well as cultural and artistic exchanges.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- Permanent missions of France: DRC: France reiterates the urgent need to protect civilian populations
- EU critical raw materials act
- CSDDD
- French Ministry for Europe and Foreign affairs
- French Duty of Vigilance Law
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international

Germany

The Federal Republic of Germany is Europe's largest economy and also one of the world's leading manufacturers of automobiles, batteries and industrial machinery, and since these industries rely a lot on critical minerals, Germany is very dependent on imported raw materials. Germany is also a part of the EU Critical Raw Materials Act which seeks to diversify mineral supplies and increase responsible sourcing and also the EU Corporate Sustainability Due Diligence Directive (CSDDD) which requires large companies to conduct human rights and environmental due diligence across their chains.

Germany supports the relief of humanitarian aid very strongly, for example when it comes to the violations in the DRC, their Federal Foreign Office states the following: ‘German development cooperation with the Democratic Republic of the Congo focuses on three core issues: engagement for peace and stability, particularly in the eastern provinces; transparent and responsible raw materials extraction, also as a contribution to the global energy transition; and access to drinking water and sustainable energy, along with protection of the rainforest to preserve its biodiversity and help in the fight against climate change.’ Through their Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development, they strongly support other emerging economies as well.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- EU Critical Raw Materials Act
- CSDDD
- Supply Chain Due Diligence Act
- Amnesty international
- Germany and Democratic Republic of the Congo: Bilateral relations
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)

India

The Republic of India is one of the world’s fastest-growing economies and because of this has very increasing demand for critical minerals for their renewable energy, electronics and manufacturing sectors. Their mining sector is growing, in alignment with increasing global demand for critical minerals, the international trade administration of the USA claims that the Indian government is looking to increase mining and processing of critical minerals in India to reduce dependency on foreign supply chains. In 2019 it established a National Mineral Policy, which promotes sustainable mining, scientific exploration, environmental protection and community participation.

Before this policy and others, the Human Rights Watch claims that in 2012, India's government had failed to ensure that the country’s 2,600 authorized mining operations adhered to key human rights and environmental protections under Indian law. In the near future of 2027, India is due to host a conference with the topic of mining critical minerals and clean energy, where they hope to ensure access to essential minerals while supporting long-term industrial and economic growth. As one of the world's major emerging economies, India helps other emerging economies by placing emphasis on South-South cooperation and also hosts Voice of Global South Summit, giving developing countries a platform to voice their concerns.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- National Mineral Policy
- Human Rights Watch- India: Mining industry out of control
- Mining Critical Minerals and Clean Energy India
- South-South Cooperation
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international

Indonesia

The Republic of Indonesia is the world's largest producer of nickel and also a key supplier of other critical minerals used in batteries and renewable energy technologies. Indonesia is a member of the Indo Pacific Economic Forum (IPEF), showing its strong commitment to developing its critical mineral resources. Indonesia focuses on their economy, in 2020 they introduced a Nickel Ore Export Ban, which prohibits exports of unprocessed nickel in order to strengthen domestic processing facilities, bring back the added value of the nickel supply chain to the Indonesian economy and also spur job creation and economic development in Indonesia. When it comes to human rights, the country is prominently featured in global reviews of human rights abuse. Near nickel mining projects, domestic and foreign companies have engaged in land grabbing, coercion and threatening on indigenous people, claims Climate Rights International. Indonesia is also a major emerging economy and one of Southeast Asia's larger economies, to help other emerging economies, they participate in South-South and triangular cooperation.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- Nickel Ore Export Ban
- IPEF
- Climate Rights International on Indonesian nickel industry
- Amnesty international
- International Trade Administration USA on Indonesia critical minerals
- South-South and triangular cooperation
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)

Japan

Japan is a country which has limited domestic mining production of critical minerals and is therefore highly dependent on imports of critical minerals for its automotive, electronics, battery and renewable-energy industries.

Japan's government has an independent administrative institution called Japan Organisation for Metals and Energy Security(JOGMEC), which supports legal compliance regarding human rights and strongly emphasises consideration for the environment. The focus of this organisation is to diversify Japan's suppliers, invest in overseas mining, develop recycling technologies and increase domestic processing. Human rights concerns take place in other countries where Japanese companies source or invest minerals. Still, it has supported supplier countries in need of aid, for example, in 2023, Japan's government helped the DRC financially, giving them approximately 1.5 million dollars. The Human Rights Watch claims that human rights issues still exist within the country. Japan is a highly developed country which strongly supports emerging economies, their development agency, JICA, is one of the world's major development cooperation institutions, which support South-South cooperation.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- Japan Organisation for metals and Energy Security(JOGMEC)- delegate can find loads of info here
- Japan Ministry of Foreign Affairs
- JICA
- South-South cooperation
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international

Nigeria

The country is increasingly positioning itself within the emerging global critical minerals sector, yet they still face structural challenges in diversifying its economy away from oil, strengthening domestic mineral industries. The Africa Policy Research Institute (APRI) launched the Roadmap for Nigeria's Critical Minerals Strategy Project in order to engage and support stakeholders such as artisanal and small-scale miners, mining companies, academic institutions and government agencies, across Nigeria's critical minerals sector. While Nigeria supports human rights, it still faces violations through for example Chinese illegal mining, which includes using the labor of child miners, the ADF magazine has stated that foreign miners make deals with criminals who offer protection in exchange for weapons and cash. This has fueled kidnappings for ransom, banditry, recruitment into criminal organizations and ongoing communal clashes. Being an emerging economy, Nigeria also supports other emerging economies, particularly within Africa through for example South-South cooperation.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- Nigeria's Critical Mineral Strategy
- International Labor Organisation on child labor in Nigeria
- South-South Cooperation
- Nigeria National Human Rights commission
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international

Russia

The Russian Federation, being the country with the biggest land mass in the world, is not only one of the world's largest producers of oil and gas, but also a producer of critical minerals essential to the global energy transition towards renewable sources, for example nickel, copper, lithium and rare earth elements. Russia has a strategy called Russian Government mineral strategy 2050, which wants to achieve the goal of ensuring long-term domestic access to mineral resources while maintaining necessary exports, meaning they seek to be self-sustainable in mineral extraction. In recent years, Russia has been trying to secure critical mineral supplies in West Africa through mercenaries, which are linked to human rights abuses, and no large-scale loss of human lives through Russia have been reported publicly. On the countries own mining companies websites, for example Nornickel, there are human rights reports claiming to generally support their workers, how these practices are implemented in host countries however hasn't been thoroughly reported. Russia supports emerging economies, presenting itself as a member of the Global Majority and promotes cooperation through BRICS.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- Russian Government mineral strategy 2050
- Human Rights Report of Nornickel
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- In the crosshairs: Twenty-first-century superpower rivalry for Africa's critical minerals-Cambridge university press
- BRICS
- Amnesty international

Saudi Arabia

On the Western coast of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, many critical minerals such as rare earth minerals, copper and zinc can be found, all of which are key players in a global renewable energy shift. However, some minerals they need to obtain overseas, such as cobalt, nickel and lithium. For this, Saudi Arabia's government has established The Critical Minerals Project, which focuses on ensuring critical mineral supply chains. In the last years, Saudi Arabia has been taking the initiative of wanting to push away from oil, with its energy minister claiming that oil is no longer the energy security challenge, instead it's going to be gas, electricity and predominantly minerals. Saudi Arabia is also a country with a large immigrant work force, making labor conditions for foreign workers an important topic for them. The kingdom of Saudi Arabia claims to care for the rights of their workers through different initiatives and decisions, despite this, the Human Rights Watch argues that the country is dabbling in slavery, migration and human trafficking through the kafala system. When it comes to emerging economies, Saudi Arabia is ready to support their development.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- International Labor Organisation on Saudi Arabia
- The critical Minerals Project Saudi Arabia/ C4IR Saudi Arabia
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international
- Saudipedia workers rights

Singapore

Singapore plays a noteworthy role in the global energy transition, the country's location itself is strategic as a major trading hub for energy and critical minerals. Singapore is actually very reliant on its petroleum and natural gas, yet it's still focused on sustainability and decarbonisation efforts. Instead of extracting raw minerals, they refine and process imported ores for batteries and electronics, which are incredibly important to the shift towards renewable energies. Therefore, Singapore is highly dependent on international supply chains concerning critical minerals and are looking for innovative ways to diversify their supply. Singapore also supports the ASEAN economic integration, which has a lot of members who identify as emerging economies who happen to be major critical mineral producers as well.

When it comes to workers' rights however, Singapore isn't often supportive, for example, the Human Rights Watch claims, that Migrant workers are excluded from a number of key labor rights protections, with visa rules giving employers unilateral power to cancel workers' employment contracts and repatriate them at will, including to unsafe countries.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- ASEAN economic community
- Singapore Government website
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)

South Africa

South Africa has one of the world's most developed mining industries, possessing amounts of critical minerals like vanadium, nickel, manganese and others which are irreplaceable for the renewable energy transition. Therefore South Africa has its own developed Critical Minerals Strategy, which aims to benefit locals, support energy transition technologies, create jobs, ensure sustainability and strengthen cross-border mineral value chains. Apart from just exporting raw materials, the country wishes to start processing and refining all of it as well. South Africa has established their own detailed Human Rights Framework, which focuses on Environmental management and conservation, health and safety, governance and ethics, security and human rights, transformation, human rights at the workplace, land-use and resettlements and development of grievance mechanisms. Due to accidents in the past, the country also has a dedicated Mine Health and Safety Inspectorate to protect miners and communities affected by mining. Being an emerging economy, South Africa also has supported and continues supporting emerging economies, for example being one of the founding members of New Development Bank, created to finance infrastructure and sustainable development in economically emerging countries.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- | | |
|---|---|
| • South Africa Critical Minerals Strategy | • UN Guiding Principles on Business and |
| • Minerals Council South Africa | • New Development Bank |
| • Human Rights Framework | • Human Rights(OHCHR) |
| • Mine Health and Safety Inspectorate | • Amnesty international |

Türkiye

Türkiye is a country that has a substantial mining sector, where it produces critical minerals such as boron, copper, zinc and rare earth minerals, which are irreplaceable for batteries and electronics, incredibly important to the shift towards renewable energies. Türkiye holds the largest reserves especially for boron on the planet. Türkiye, while not an emerging economy, has had disasters related to the mining industry in the past, especially in 2014, where 301 miners perished in a mining related accident within a coal mine, in which a mine burned for two days straight, bringing attention to workers, mining and construction safety as well as labor rights and also the environment. Coming to the topic of emerging economies, Türkiye has established a development-cooperation institution, called the Turkish Cooperation and Coordination Agency, which operates in more than 170 countries with different projects, therefore Türkiye is indeed a strong supporter of emerging economies.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- International labor organisation in affiliation with Türkiye
- 2014 Türkiye mining disaster
- Türkiye's mining regulations
- Amnesty international
- Turkish cooperation and coordination agency
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)

United Kingdom

The United Kingdom has relatively limited domestic mining, only producing critical minerals like lithium, tungsten, nickel and some others. These critical minerals are very important for the shift towards renewable energies to create for example electric vehicles or batteries. The kingdom has developed its Critical Minerals Strategy 2035, which aims to reduce overreliance on importer countries, although not completely shutting it out, since domestic mining alone won't satisfy the demand of the country, as well as enhance international markets to make them more responsive, transparent and responsible. To mention, the country has had a number of mining related accidents in the past, especially in the coal mining industry, and although coal isn't a critical mineral, the accidents related still impact the countries Critical Minerals Strategy.

Emphasising human rights, the UK has implemented other measures that support miners, for example the Modern Slavery Act 2015, which requires certain UK companies to annually publish statements regarding the steps taken to prevent modern slavery and human trafficking. Coming to the question of supporting emerging economies, the Critical Minerals Strategy claims that it wants to benefit resource rich emerging economies by for example investment, processing and capacity building.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- UK Critical Minerals Strategy 2035
- Major Mining Disasters in Britain
- Modern Slavery Act 2015
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)
- Amnesty international

United States

The United States of America has substantial domestic mineral production, yet for many critical minerals like lithium, cobalt, nickel and so on it remains dependent on importer countries. Critical minerals serve a significant importance for creating for example electric vehicles and batteries as well as defence and military mechanisms. The Whitehouse claims that this huge dependence comes at a risk of national security, defence readiness and price stability. For this reason, the US is looking to enhance its domestic production, with aims not only to mine but also to refine, process and recycle, as well as allied production and alternative suppliers. Through this, the US International Development Finance Corporation Board(DFC) has approved a 2.5 billion dollar investment into advancing critical minerals alongside infrastructure. The USA supports emerging economies rich in critical minerals, in 2025 they implemented the Strategic Partnership Agreement Between the Government of the United States of America and the Government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo to advance the development of the country's mining sector. The International Monetary Fund released a blog claiming that the latest US frameworks and policies have contributed to helping emerging economies to resist shock in market resilience. To add, the US also has a Minerals Security Partnership which includes the need for ethical and transparent business operations, community benefits and supply chain due-diligence.

Relevant policies, keywords and websites for further research:

- 2026 USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries
- Ensuring National Security and Economic Resilience Through Section 232 Actions On Processed Critical Minerals and Derivative Products
- Minerals Security Partnerships
- Amnesty international
- Strategic Partnership Agreement Between the Government of the United States of America and the Government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo
- DFC investments in critical minerals
- UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights(OHCHR)

